

Homework 4: Practicing Charismatic Fillers in Daily Conversations

Due Date: October 14, 2025

Introduction

This homework is designed to help you master the use of 20 charismatic fillers in daily conversations. By practicing these fillers over the next 7 days, you will enhance your ability to sound confident, engaging, and natural while maintaining conversational flow. Each exercise targets specific fillers and scenarios to ensure practical application.

Objectives

- Understand the purpose and effect of each charismatic filler.
- Practice using fillers in real-life conversations to build confidence.
- Develop a natural, charismatic speaking style that avoids overuse or awkwardness.

List of 20 Charismatic Fillers

Below is a quick reference for the 20 charismatic fillers you will practice. Use this as a guide for the exercises.

1. **Well:** Start a response thoughtfully or transition to a new point.
2. **So:** Summarize or transition to a conclusion.
3. **I mean:** Clarify or rephrase a statement.
4. **You see:** Emphasize a point or invite understanding.
5. **Actually:** Correct, add a fact, or emphasize truth.
6. **Right?:** Check agreement or engage listeners.
7. **You know:** Build rapport by assuming shared understanding.
8. **Now:** Shift focus or introduce a new topic.
9. **Look:** Grab attention or emphasize urgency.
10. **Honestly:** Convey sincerity or conviction.
11. **By the way:** Introduce a side point or anecdote.
12. **In fact:** Reinforce a point with evidence.
13. **To be honest:** Show transparency and relatability.
14. **Let's say:** Introduce a hypothetical or example.
15. **Frankly:** Express directness or boldness.

16. **As it happens:** Introduce a relevant fact or coincidence.
17. **At the end of the day:** Summarize or emphasize the bottom line.
18. **Here's the thing:** Focus on a key point or problem.
19. **To put it simply:** Clarify complex ideas.
20. **After all:** Justify or reinforce a point.

Daily Exercises (7 Days)

Complete one exercise per day. Each exercise focuses on specific fillers and scenarios. Record your progress in a journal (template provided at the end) and reflect on how the fillers impacted your conversations.

Day 1: Starting Conversations (Well, Now, Look)

- **Task:** Use "Well," "Now," and "Look" at least 3 times each in conversations (e.g., with friends, colleagues, or family).
- **Scenarios:**
 - Start a discussion: "Well, I've been thinking about our weekend plans."
 - Shift topics: "Now, let's talk about dinner options."
 - Emphasize urgency: "Look, we need to decide by tonight."
- **Goal:** Practice initiating and transitioning in conversations smoothly.

Day 2: Clarifying and Engaging (I mean, You see, Right?)

- **Task:** Use "I mean," "You see," and "Right?" at least 3 times each in conversations.
- **Scenarios:**
 - Clarify a point: "We need to finish this, I mean, it's due tomorrow."
 - Emphasize understanding: "You see, this approach saves time."
 - Engage listeners: "That's a great idea, right?"
- **Goal:** Make your speech interactive and clear.

Day 3: Building Rapport (You know, To be honest, Honestly)

- **Task:** Use "You know," "To be honest," and "Honestly" at least 3 times each in casual conversations.
- **Scenarios:**
 - Connect casually: "You know, I love this coffee shop."
 - Show transparency: "To be honest, I'm nervous about the presentation."

- Add sincerity: “Honestly, this is our best work yet.”
- **Goal:** Sound relatable and trustworthy.

Day 4: Adding Authority (Actually, In fact, Frankly)

- **Task:** Use “Actually,” “In fact,” and “Frankly” at least 3 times each in professional or serious discussions.
- **Scenarios:**
 - Correct a point: “Actually, the deadline is next week.”
 - Reinforce with evidence: “In fact, our data supports this.”
 - Be bold: “Frankly, we need a better plan.”
- **Goal:** Sound confident and credible.

Day 5: Introducing Ideas (By the way, As it happens, Let’s say)

- **Task:** Use “By the way,” “As it happens,” and “Let’s say” at least 3 times each in conversations.
- **Scenarios:**
 - Add a side point: “By the way, I met the new manager.”
 - Share a fact: “As it happens, I read about that yesterday.”
 - Propose a scenario: “Let’s say we finish early—what’s next?”
- **Goal:** Introduce new ideas smoothly and naturally.

Day 6: Summarizing and Simplifying (So, To put it simply, At the end of the day)

- **Task:** Use “So,” “To put it simply,” and “At the end of the day” at least 3 times each in conversations.
- **Scenarios:**
 - Conclude a point: “So, we’re moving forward with the plan.”
 - Simplify: “To put it simply, we need more time.”
 - Summarize: “At the end of the day, it’s about results.”
- **Goal:** Wrap up ideas clearly and impactfully.

Day 7: Mixed Practice and Reflection

- **Task:** Use any 5 fillers of your choice at least 3 times each in any conversation. Reflect on your progress.
- **Scenarios:** Choose any from the previous days or create your own.

- **Goal:** Build confidence in using fillers naturally and assess your improvement.

Tips for Success

- **Limit Fillers:** Use no more than 2-3 fillers per minute to avoid sounding hesitant.
- **Pause Strategically:** Replace excessive fillers with 1-2 second pauses to show confidence.
- **Match Context:** Use bold fillers (e.g., "Frankly") in serious moments and softer ones (e.g., "You see") in casual settings.
- **Record Yourself:** Use your phone to record a conversation (with permission) and review your filler use.
- **Journal:** Track your progress daily using the template below.

Journal Template

For each day, answer the following in your journal:

1. Which fillers did you use, and in what scenarios?
2. How did the fillers impact the conversation (e.g., engagement, clarity)?
3. What felt natural, and what needs improvement?

Submit your journal with your homework by October 14, 2025.

Submission Instructions

- Complete all 7 days of exercises.
- Submit your journal (handwritten or typed) summarizing your filler use and reflections.
- Email your submission to your instructor by 11:59 PM on October 14, 2025, or as instructed.